The 18th Advanced Fieldcourse in Ecology and Conservation, XTBG (AFEC-X 2026)

Schedule on Oct 15 to Nov 27, 2026 (UTC+8) (44 days)
Yunnan, China

MON	DATE	DAY	TIME	Activity	Host	Place
Oct	15-16	Thu-Fri	Whole day	Arrival and registration	HH, SL et al.	Boshida Hotel
	16	Fri	16:00-17:30	Frisbee	AN et al.	Flower Garden
			18:30-21:00	Welcome Dinner	HH et al.	Teng Ming Wu
				Opening Ceremony		
	17	Sat	08:20	Shuttle bus from Flower Garden to Research Center		Entrance of Flower Garden
			09:00-09:05	Introduce the guests and students	XX	Conference Hall
			09:05-09:20	Course introduction	CJ	Conference Hall
			09:20-09:30	Remark from XTBG and course opening	QRC	Conference Hall
			09:30-10:10	Group photo and break	MXX, HH	Coffee Bar
			10:10-11:40	K: In-situ, ex-situ, and re-situ conservation in the Anthropocene	CC	Conference Hall
				Orientation and ice-breaker		
			12:00-13:00	Lunch		Staff Canteen
			14:00-15:30	K: Plant ex-situ conservation, Chinese national botanical garden system	CJ	Meeting Room 2

			15:30-18:30	Familiar with XTBG; Temporary Residence Permit for International Students	XX, HH et al.	West campus & Rainforest
			18:30-19:00	Dinner		Staff Canteen
			19:00-19:15	Course arrangement; Signing of the security responsibility letter	XX, SL	Meeting Room 2
			19:15-20:45	P: Student self-introduction (2-1) (5 minutes each via PPT, 15 people)	WXW, WMH	Meeting Room 2
			21:00	Shuttle bus from Research Center to Flower Garden	HH et al.	In Front of Administration Building
				Module 1: Theoretical Lectures (3 days)		
				Theme: Tropical Biology, Conservation Biology		
	18	Sun	09:00-10:20	L: Floral diversity of tropical east Asia	KT	Meeting Room 2
			10:20-12:20	P: Under drought stress: visit limestone forest	KT	Limestone Forest
			12:30-13:00	Lunch		Staff Canteen
			13:00-14:00	P: Match Meeting (7-1): Conservation / Ecology	Students, CC	
			14:30-15:30	L: Biodiversity threats and solutions	CM	Meeting Room 2
			15:40-16:40	P: Discussing the biodiversity threats of students' own countries and solutions (grouping by countries/regions)	Students	Meeting Room 2
			16:40-17:30	P: Presenting the results of discussion by groups (5 min each group)	Students, CM	Meeting Room 2
			17:30-18:00	P: Conservation role play (2-1): introduction & role assignment (+ reading materials distribution)	CM, PK	Meeting Room 2

			18:00-19:00	Dinner		Staff Canteen
			19:00-20:30	P: Student self-introduction (2-2) (5 minutes each via PPT, 15 people)	WXW, WMH	Meeting Room 2
			20:40	Shuttle bus from Research Center to Flower Garden	HH et al.	In Front of Administration Building
				Theme: Tropical Biology, Animal-plant Interaction, Conservation Biology		
	19	Mon	08:20	Shuttle bus from Bamboo Collection to Research Center		Entrance of Flower Garden
			09:00-10:20	K: What is Ecology and Conservation?	ACA	
			10:30-11:30	L: The mega-fauna of Tropical Asia	ACA	Meeting Room 2
			11:30-12:30	L: Seed dispersal and pollination	ACA	Meeting Room 2
			12:30-13:30	Lunch		Staff Canteen
			14:30-16:00	L: Human-wildlife Conflicts	ACA	
			16:30-18:00	L: Principles of evidence-based conservation	ACA	
			18:00-19:00	Dinner		Staff Canteen
			19:00-20:30	P: Student individual research project presentations, along with poster sessions (2-1) (5 minutes each via PPT, 15 presentations)	WXW, WMH	Meeting Room 2
			20:40	Shuttle bus from Research Center to Flower Garden	HH et al.	In Front of Administration Building
				Theme: Animal-plant Interaction		
	20	Tue	08:20	Shuttle bus from Flower Garden to Research Center		Entrance of Flower Garden
			09:00-10:30	L: Trait evolution in plants and animals and coevolutionary species diversification	WG	Meeting Room 2

			10:40-12:00	P: Trait evolution in plants and animals and coevolutionary species diversification	WG	Research Center
			12:00-13:00	Lunch		Staff Canteen
			14:30-17:00	P: Conservation role play (2-2): debate	CM, PK	Meeting Room 2
			17:10-18:00	L&P: Preview statistics and debug R software to prepare for statistics workshop	Nina / MJ	Meeting Room 2
			18:00-19:00	Dinner		Staff Canteen
			19:00-20:30	P: Student individual research project presentations, along with poster sessions (2-2) (5 minutes each via PPT, 15 presentations)	WXW, WMH	Meeting Room 2
			20:40	Shuttle bus from Research Center to Flower Garden	HH et al.	In Front of Administration Building
				Module 2: Research Technologies (19 days)		
				Workshop: Experimental Design and Statistics in R (6 days)		
	21-26	Wed-Mon	08:20	Shuttle bus from Bamboo Collection to Research Center		Entrance of Flower Garden
			09:00-12:00	L&P: Experimental design and Statistics in R	KT et al.	Meeting Room 2
			12:00-13:00	Lunch		Staff Canteen
			14:00-18:00	L&P: Experimental design and Statistics in R	KT et al.	Meeting Room 2
			18:00-19:00	Dinner		Staff Canteen
	21-23	Wed-Fri	19:00-20:30	L&P: Bayesian	MK	Meeting Room 2
	24	Sat	19:00-21:00	Sports (Voluntarily sign up)	WMH, LWZ	3H
	25	Sun	19:00-21:00	Night Watching	HH et al.	TBD
	26	Mon	17:30-18:00	L: Why we have 'Independent project' and rules	KT	Meeting Room 2
			18:00-19:00	Dinner		Staff Canteen

			19:00-20:30	L: Conservation education and behavioral change	HSF	Meeting Room 2
			20:30-20:40	P: Fieldwork arrangement	HH et al.	Meeting Room 2
			20:45	Shuttle bus from Research Center to Flower Garden	HH et al.	In Front of Administration Building
	27-29	Tue-Thu		**Field Course 2-1: Yuanjiang Field Course (3 days)**		
	27	Tue	08:00	Leave XTBG by bus to Yuanjiang Station		
			15:00	Arrival and check in Yuanjiang station		
			16:00-16:30	L: Introduction to Yuanjiang station and staff	WHD	
			16:30-18:00	P: Field survey	KT, LJJ, AN et al.	
			18:00-19:00	Dinner		
			19:00-20:30	L: Savanna vegetation: evolutionary history and conservation significance	KT	
	28	Wed	08:00	Breakfast		
			09:00-12:00	P: Field survey	KT, LJJ, AN et al.	
			12:00-13:00	Lunch		
			13:00-14:00	P: Match Meeting (7-2,3): Conservation / Ecology	KT, LJJ, AN	
			14:00-15:30	L: How to come up with a solid, relevant, and real-world scientific question that's worth investigating?	LJJ	
			16:00-18:00	P: Field survey	KT, LJJ, AN et al.	
			18:00-19:00	Dinner		
			19:00-20:30	L: Strategies for selecting the right journal to publish your scientific findings: what to consider and how to make a good match	LJJ	
	29	Thu	08:00	Breakfast		

			09:00	Back to XTBG from Yuanjiang Station		
			17:30-19:30	Dinner	Menglun Town	
	30	Fri		**Free Day**		
				Lunch and Dinner	HH	Sign up at Teng Ming Wu or Staff Canteen
				Workshop: Large Language Models; Question Quest		
	31	Sat	08:20	Walk to Environmental Education Center (EEC)		
			09:00-12:00	L & P: Large language models	CM	EEC 218
			12:00-13:00	Lunch		Teng Ming Wu
			13:00-14:00	P: Match Meeting (7-4): Conservation Education	Students, HSF	
			13:00-14:00	P: Match Meeting (7-5): Conservation Biology	Students, CM	
			14:30-18:00	P: Question Quest: exploration & question generation (Students explore XTBG in small groups using the provided exploration map to identify scientific questions. Each group comes up with 3 scientific questions they are most interested in and consider most worth studying) (2-1)	Students, XX, MXX	
			18:00-19:00	Dinner		Teng Ming Wu
			19:00-21:00	P: Question Quest: Sharing our scientific questions (Groups share their scientific questions) (2-2)	Students, CJ, AN, CM, PK et al.	EEC 218
			21:10	Walk back to the hotel		
				Workshop: Insect Ecology (2-1); Community Ecology (3-1)		
Nov	1	Sun	08:20	Walk to EEC		
			09:00-10:00	L: Insect ecology and sampling techniques	AN	EEC 218
			10:20-12:00	L: Community Ecology	AN	EEC 218

			12:00-13:00	Lunch		Teng Ming Wu
			14:00-18:00	P: Insect sampling in the rubber plantation and rain forest	AN et al.	East Campus
			18:30-20:30	BBQ		Lan Pa Wan
				Workshop: Species Distribution Modelling (1 day)		
	2	Mon	08:20	Shuttle bus from Bamboo Collection to Research Center		Entrance of Flower Garden
			09:00-12:00	L & P: Species distribution modelling	AM	Meeting Room 2
			12:00-13:00	Lunch		Staff Canteen
			14:30-18:00	L & P: Species distribution modelling	AM	Meeting Room 2
			18:00-19:00	Dinner		Staff Canteen
			19:00-21:00	L & P: Species distribution modelling	AM	Meeting Room 2
			21:00-21:20	P: What can canopy leaf temperature tell us? (3-1): Literature reading (grouping)	XX	Meeting Room 2
			21:30	Shuttle bus from Research Center to Flower Garden		In Front of Administration Building
				Workshop: Community Ecology (3-2)		
	3	Tue	08:20	Shuttle bus from Bamboo Collection to Research Center		
			09:00-12:00	L&P: Community Ecology	AN	Meeting Room 2
			12:00-13:00	Lunch		
			14:30-18:00	L&P: Community Ecology	AN, MK et al.	Meeting Room 2
			18:00-19:00	Dinner		
			19:00-21:00	L&P: Community Ecology	AN, MK et al.	Meeting Room 2

			21:10	Shuttle bus from Research Center to Flower Garden		
				Workshop: Insect Ecology (2-2); Community Ecology (3-3)		
	4	Wed	08:20	Shuttle bus from Bamboo Collection to Rubber Plantation		
			08:30-09:30	P: Insect traps collection and insect sampling pretreatment	AN et al.	East Campus
			10:00-12:00	L&P: Community Ecology	AN, MK et al.	Meeting Room 2
			12:00-13:00	Lunch		
			13:00-14:00	P: Match Meeting (7-6): Ecology/Conservation Biology/Education	Students, CJ	
			13:00-14:00	P: Match Meeting (7-7): Ecology/Conservation Biology/Education	Students, AN	
			14:30-18:00	L&P: Community Ecology	AN, MK et al.	Meeting Room 2
			18:00-19:00	Dinner		
			19:00-21:00	P: Insect identification	Students	Lab of Forest Canopy Ecology Group
			21:10	Shuttle bus from Research Center to Flower Garden		
				Workshop: Tree Climbing; DNA Data and Conservation (2-1)		
	5	Thu	08:20	Shuttle bus from Bamboo Collection to Kindergarten		
			09:00-12:30	P: Tree climbing training	AN et al.	Lawn in Front of Kindergarten
			12:30-13:30	Lunch		Staff Canteen
			14:30-18:00	L&P: DNA data and conservation	YI	Meeting Room 2
			18:00-19:00	Dinner		Staff Canteen
			19:00-20:30	L: Plant genomics research, and botanical systematics (taxonomy) and evolution promote conservation	CC	Meeting Room 2

			20:40	Shuttle bus from Research Center to Flower Garden		In Front of Administration Building
				Workshop: DNA Data and Conservation (2-2); Thermal Ecology		
	6	Fri	08:20	Shuttle bus from Bamboo Collection to Research Center		Entrance of Flower Garden
			09:00-12:00	L&P: DNA data and conservation	YI	Meeting Room 2
			12:00-13:00	Lunch		Staff Canteen
			14:30-16:00	P: What can canopy leaf temperature tell us? (3-2): Literature review by groups via PPT	Students, LH	Meeting Room 2
			16:20-18:00	L: What can canopy leaf temperature tell us? (3-3)	LH	Meeting Room 2
			18:00-19:00	Dinner		Staff Canteen
			19:00-21:00	L: Xishuangbanna tropical rain forest ecosystem positioning research station & Bubeng plot introduction	LHZ	Meeting Room 2
			21:00-21:10	P: Fieldwork arrangement	HH et al.	Meeting Room 2
			21:10	Shuttle bus from Research Center to Flower Garden		In Front of Administration Building
	7-8	Sat-Sun		**Field Course 2-2: National Forest Ecosystem Research Station at Xishuangbanna (Bubeng Plot) (2 days)**		
	7	Sat	08:00	Leave XTBG by bus to Bubeng plot		
			10:00	Arrival and check in Bubeng Field Station	AN, SXY et al.	
			10:30-12:30	P: Familiarity with fieldwork plot (Xishuangbanna dynamic sample plot of 20 hectares tropical seasonal rainforest)	DJL et al.	
			12:30-13:30	Lunch		
			14:00-17:30	P: Canopy crane study & field work	Group 1, AN et al.	
			14:00-17:30	P: Forest permanent sample plot construction	Group 2, SXY et al.	
			18:00-19:00	Dinner		

			19:00-20:30	L: AI and Diversity Monitoring	Hongtei	Meeting Room
			20:30-21:30	P: Independent project idea sharing	Students, instructors	Meeting Room
	8	Sun	08:00	Breakfast		
			08:30-12:30	P: Canopy crane study & field work	Group 2, AN et al.	Meeting Room
			08:30-12:30	P: Forest permanent sample plot construction	Group 1, SXY et al.	
			13:30-14:30	Lunch		Bubeng Station
			15:00-17:00	Back to XTBG from Bubeng		
			18:00-19:00	Dinner	HH	TBD
				Module 3: Independent Project (17 days)		
	9	Mon		**Free Day** (Exploring the research site / preparing your study plan)		
				Lunch and Dinner	HH	Sigh up at Teng Min Wu or Staff Canteen
	10-12	Tue-Thu		**Independent Project Proposal (3 days)**		
	10	Tue	08:20	Shuttle bus from Bamboo Collection to Research Center		Entrance of Flower Garden
			09:00-12:00	P: Independent project proposal presentation by groups_1st round	Students, instructors	Meeting Room 2
			12:00-13:00	Lunch		Staff Canteen
			14:30-18:00	P: Independent project proposal improvement by groups	Students, instructors	Meeting Room 2
			18:00-19:00	Dinner		Staff Canteen
			19:00-21:00	P: Independent project proposal improvement by groups	Students	Meeting Room 2
			21:10	Shuttle bus from Research Center to Flower Garden		In Front of Administration Building

	11	Wed	08:20	Shuttle bus from Bamboo Collection to Research Center		Entrance of Flower Garden
			09:00-12:00	P: Independent project proposal presentation by groups_2nd round	Students, instructors	Meeting Room 2
			12:00-13:00	Lunch		Staff Canteen
			14:30-18:00	P: Independent project proposal improvement by groups	Students, instructors	Meeting Room 2
			18:00-19:00	Dinner		Staff Canteen
			19:00-21:00	P: Independent project proposal improvement by groups	Students	Meeting Room 2
			21:10	Shuttle bus from Research Center to Flower Garden		In Front of Administration Building
	12	Thu	08:20	Shuttle bus from Bamboo Collection to Research Center		Entrance of Flower Garden
			09:00-12:00	Preparing for data collection (whose proposals have been approved); improving independent project proposal (the rest)	Students, instructors	Meeting Room 2
			12:00-13:00	Lunch		Staff Canteen
			14:00-18:00	Preparing for data collection (whose proposals have been approved); improving independent project proposal (the rest)	Students, instructors	Meeting Room 2
			18:00-19:00	Dinner		Staff Canteen
			19:00-21:00	Preparing for data collection (whose proposals have been approved)	Students, instructors	Meeting Room 2
			21:10	Shuttle bus from Research Center to Flower Garden		In Front of Administration Building
	13-19	Fri-Thu		**Data Collection (7 days)**		
	13-19	Fri-Thu	08:00-12:00	P: Data collection		
			12:00-13:00	Lunch		Staff Canteen
			14:00-18:00	P: Data collection		Meeting Room 2
			18:00-19:00	Dinner		Staff Canteen

			19:00-21:00	P: Problem discussion with your project instructor and group members	Students, instructors	Meeting Room 2
			21:10	Shuttle bus from Research Center to Flower Garden		In Front of Administration Building
	17	Tue	19:00-21:00	Mid-term progress report (2-1)	Students, instructors	
				Data Analysis and Report Writing (3 days)		
	20-22	Fri-Sun	08:20	Shuttle bus from Bamboo Collection to Research Center		Entrance of Flower Garden
			09:00-12:00	P: Data analysis and report writing		Meeting Room 2
			12:00-13:00	Lunch		Staff Canteen
			14:00-18:00	P: Data analysis and report writing		Meeting Room 2
			18:00-19:00	Dinner		Staff Canteen
			19:00-21:00	P: Problem discussion with your project instructor and group members	Students, instructors	Meeting Room 2
			21:10	Shuttle bus from Research Center to Flower Garden		In Front of Administration Building
	22	Sun	16:00-18:00	Mid-term progress report (2-2)	Students, instructors	
				Preparing the Presentation Slides (2 days)		
	23-24	Mon-Tue	08:20	Shuttle bus from Bamboo Collection to Research Center		Entrance of Flower Garden
			09:00-12:00	P: PPT making		Meeting Room 2
			12:00-13:00	Lunch		Staff Canteen
			14:00-18:00	P: PPT making		Meeting Room 2
			18:00-19:00	Dinner		Staff Canteen
			19:00-21:00	P: Problem discussion with your project instructor and group members	Students, instructors	Meeting Room 2

			21:10	Shuttle bus from Research Center to Flower Garden		In Front of Administration Building
				Course Symposium + Closing Ceremony		
	25	Wed	08:20	Shuttle bus from Bamboo Collection to Research Center		Entrance of Flower Garden
			09:00-11:30	PPT & Report Submit, get ready for project presentation		Meeting Room 2
			11:30-12:30	Lunch		Staff Canteen
				Course Symposium		
			13:00-16:00	Independent project presentation (for each project, 15 min + 5 min QA)		Conference Hall
			16:00-16:30	Judges evaluate the best project	XX	Conference Hall
			16:30-17:00	Course evaluation & best project awards		Conference Hall
				Closing Ceremony		
			17:00-17:10	Course review	XX	Conference Hall
			17:10-17:30	Students and instructors share their thoughts about the course		Conference Hall
			17:30-17:45	Remarks from AFEC-X 2026	CJ	Conference Hall
			17:45-18:00	Remarks from XTBG	XYW	Conference Hall
			19:00-21:00	Farewell dinner	HH et al.	TBD
	26	Thu	Whole days	Adapting your projects into hands-on science activities for primary school students (aged 8-12) or XTBG tourists (voluntarily sign up in groups before Nov 8, no more than 3 projects)	XX et al.	
	26-27	Thu-Fri	Whole days	**Departure**	HH, SL et al.	

Faculty

Num	Code	Full Name
1	ACA	Ahimsa Campos-Arceiz
2	AM	Ali Maroof
3	AN	Akihiro Nakamura
4	CC	Charles Cannon
5	CJ	CHEN Jin 陈进
6	CM	Christos Mammides
7	DJL	DONG Jin-long 董金龙
8	HH	HE He 贺赫
9	Hongtei	Chitsanuphong Phanthian
10	HSF	HU Si-fan 胡思帆
11	KT	Kyle Tomlinson
12	LH	LIN Hua 林华
13	LHZ	LU Hua-zheng 卢华正
14	LJJ	LIU Jia-jia 刘佳佳
15	LWZ	LI Wen-zhuo 李文卓
16	MJ	Mark Jun M. Alcantara
17	MK	Masatoshi Katabuchi
18	MXX	MO Xiao-xue 莫晓雪
19	Nina	Ma. Niña Regina Quibod
20	PK	Pratibha Khatri Sharma
21	QRC	QUAN Rui-chang 权锐昌
22	SL	SUN Li 孙丽
23	SXY	SONG Xiao-yang 宋晓阳
24	WG	WANG Gang 王刚
25	WHD	WEN Han-dong 温韩东
26	WMH	WANG Ming-hui 王明惠
27	WXW	WANG Xin-wei 王昕玮
28	XX	XIA Xue 夏雪
29	YI	Yuichi Isaka